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Private Managed Forest Land

The Private Managed Forest Land Program was established in 2003 under the Private Managed Forest Land Act, under which landowners commit to manage their property for long-term forest production, including meeting legislated objectives for key public environmental values.

Managed Forest Land

Private land in British Columbia accounts for a small percentage of the province's land base (approximately 4.5 million hectares or 5%). The origins of private land date back to the early part of the province's establishment when land was granted by the Crown for railroad construction, settlement and mining. One of the most significant grants occurred in 1884 on southeastern Vancouver Island, when about 850,000 hectares was granted to local entrepreneurs in return for the E&N Railway construction.

Due to its historical origin, much of the private forest land in B.C. is located near communities on productive land that is highly valued for multiple resources including timber production, fish and wildlife habitat, drinking water, and recreation. The majority of private forest land is located on southeastern Vancouver Island, and in the Kootenay region.

Managed forest is a BC Assessment Authority land classification established in 1988 to encourage private landowners to manage their lands for long-term forest production.

To be eligible for classification as managed forest, land must be a minimum of 25 hectares and be suitable for growing trees. The owner must commit to use the property for production and harvesting of timber and associated forest management activities.

Most managed forest is part of the Private Managed Forest Land Program under the Private Managed Forest Land Act.

Of the 4.5 million hectares of private land in B.C., representing approximately 5% of the provincial land base, just over one million hectares is classed as managed forest and is subject to forest practices regulation.

Legislation

- [BC Laws](#)
- [Private Managed Forest Land Act](#)
- [Private Managed Forest Land Act, Regulations](#)

Related Links

- [Managed Forest Council](#)
- [Private Managed Forest Land Owners Association](#)
- [BC Assessment - Managed Forest Classification in British Columbia](#)

Contact Information

Contact us if you have questions about the management of private forest land in B.C.

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